

THOMAS CHARRAYRE

1 Place Saint-Thomas, Paris, 75006 • thomas.charrayre@gmail.com

Third year **PhD student in political theory** at Sciences Po Paris, attached to the *Centre de recherches politiques de Sciences Po* (CEVIPOF) working on the theory and history of conservative thought. Full command of English, French and German.

EDUCATION

SCIENCES PO PARIS	Paris, France
Doctoral student	2023-
Supervisors: Gil Delannoi and Florent Guénard	
Dissertation: “Mapping conservative thought. A comparative history of the philosophies of Leo Strauss, Michael Oakeshott and Raymond Aron”	
ECOLE NORMALE SUPERIEURE DE PARIS (ENS ULM)	Paris, France
Scholarship student in the Philosophy Department (~52.000€)	2019-2023
Tutor: Florent Guénard	
FREE UNIVERSITY OF BRUSSELS (ULB)	Brussels, Belgium
Master’s degree in Political Philosophy	2021-2022
Highest Honors	
SCIENCES PO PARIS	Paris, France
Master’s degree in Political Science	2019-2021
Highest Honors	
JEAN MOULIN UNIVERSITY (LYON III)	Lyon, France
Bachelor’s degree in Philosophy	2016-2019
Highest Honors	

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

CAMBRIDGE UNIVERSITY	Cambridge, United-Kingdom
History Faculty & Department of Politics and International Studies	2025
Visiting Student (4 months) – host: Prof. Richard Bourke (2.500€ Scholarship)	
JOHNS HOPKINS UNIVERSITY	Baltimore, MD
Comparative Thought and Literature Department	2022-2023
Visiting Scholar (one year) – host: Prof. Lisa Siraganian (12.000\$ Fellowship)	

RESEARCH INTERESTS

In my dissertation, I seek to show that, despite the difficulties we face when defining conservatism, it is nevertheless a relevant category of interpretation in the history of ideas. But, in opposition to attempts to establish a conservative tradition, I emphasize the differences between conservative thinkers (Aron, Oakeshott, Strauss) in order to identify the common intention that underlies their philosophies: a reworking of the liberal-democratic notion of the *rule of law*.

Keywords: Political theory; Conservatism; Liberalism; Democratic Theory; History.

PUBLICATIONS

CHARRAYRE, Thomas & MIRANDA, Arnaud. “A thin line: distinguishing between conservatism and Reaction”, *under review*.

CHARRAYRE, Thomas. « Review : Boussac (Tamara), L’affaire de Newburgh. Aux origines du nouveau conservatisme américain », *Revue Française de Sciences Politiques*, Spring 2026.

CHARRAYRE, Thomas. “Où sont passés les conservateurs ?”, *La Vie des Idées*, January 2026.

CHARRAYRE, Thomas. “Review: Châton (Gwendal), *Calmann-Lévy, éditeur engagé. Défendre l’antitotalitarisme dans la guerre froide des idées*”, *Revue Française de Sciences Politiques*, Spring 2025.

CHARRAYRE, Thomas. “The Liberals’ Cold War”, *Books and Ideas*, January 2025.

CHARRAYRE, Thomas. “Anatomie de la droite conservatrice”, *La Vie des Idées*, January 2024.

SELECTED TALKS

“What was Conservative democracy?”, invited talk, *Knapp Foundation*, February 23, 2026.

“What was Cold War Conservatism?”, History of Political Thought Graduate Seminar, Cambridge University, November 3, 2025.

“Is there a non-traditionalist kind of conservatism?”, Political Science Association Conservatism Studies Group, Hull University, October 28, 2025.

“The Three Waves of Conservative Democracy: Burke, Oakeshott and Fukuyama against Postliberalism”, *Paris Workshop in Political Theory*, June 20, 2025.

“The Authority of Nature and the Politics of Conservation: Leo Strauss and the Problem of Authority”, Graduate Conference in Philosophy, *Utrecht University*, May 8, 2025.

“A Thin Line: On the Distinction between Conservatism and Reaction”, with Arnaud Miranda, Séminaire Mobilisations conservatrices, *EHESS*, February 27, 2025.

“Democracy after liberal democracy: the postliberal Right in the age of Trump”, Conference “After the Election: American Democracy in the Shadow of Trumpism” *University of Chicago* in Paris, January 23, 2025.

“Existe-t-il une théorie conservatrice de la démocratie?”, *Congress of the Belgian Political Science Association*, Liège University, February 1-2, 2024

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

CAMBRIDGE UNIVERSITY	Cambridge, United-Kingdom
History & Political Science	2025
<i>The History of Political Thought since c. 1890</i> , Third years, 12 supervisions.	

SCIENCES PO PARIS	Paris, France
Political Science & Philosophy	2024 – 2026
<i>Introduction to Political Theory</i> , Second years, 20 students, 24 hours of lectures.	
<i>Introduction to Political Science</i> , First years, 63 students. 3×24 hours of lectures.	
<i>History of the Modern State</i> , Second years, 74 students. Teaching Assistant.	
<i>History and Theory of Conservatism</i> , Second years, 20 students, 24 hours of lectures.	

SAINT-DENIS UNIVERSITY (PARIS-8)	Saint-Denis, France
Political Science	January 2025 – May 2025
<i>Introduction to Political Theory</i> , First years, 68 students, 39 hours of lectures.	

JOHNS HOPKINS UNIVERSITY	Baltimore, MD
Comparative Thought and Literature Department	February 2023 – May 2023
<i>Marxism/s</i> , Graduate students, 6 lectures given as a graduate seminar.	

REFERENCES

Daniel Steinmetz-Jenkins, Assistant professor Wesleyan University, dsteinmetzje@wesleyan.edu
Greg Conti, Associate professor at Princeton University, gaconti@princeton.edu